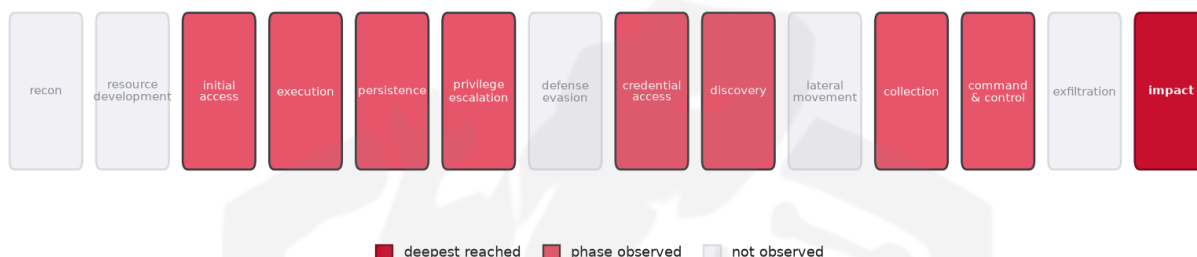


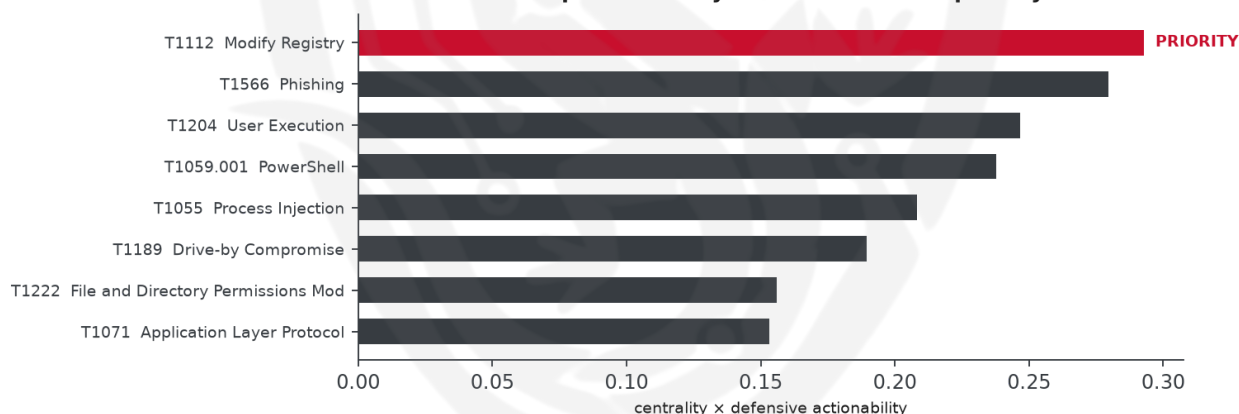
THREAT REPORT: VOID ARACHNE DISABLES WINDOWS UPDATE WITH FAKE INSTALLERS

Visual Summary

Kill-Chain Reach — Critical (deepest phase reached: impact)



Defensive Chokepoint — why this control is the priority



The control that most disrupts the attack (priority in crimson).

Summary

Void Arachne distributes counterfeit software installers that tamper with Windows Update settings and weaken Microsoft Defender. The campaign leverages a range of malware families—including gh0st RAT, Mydoor, Moudoor, ValleyRAT, and the Silver Fox trojan—against organizations in China across healthcare, manufacturing, technology, government, and education sectors. No specific CVE is identified for the exploit. Priority should be given to monitoring sensitive registry keys for modification and restricting registry-edit tools for unprivileged users.

Threat Overview

The source attributes this activity to Void Arachne. The malicious payloads belong to the gh0st RAT, Mydoor, Moudoor, ValleyRAT, and Silver Fox trojan families. No concrete vulnerability (CVE) is cited in the

source. Victims are primarily Chinese entities operating in the listed critical sectors.

Attack Chain and Priority Control

The observed chain begins with phishing or drive-by compromise to deliver fake installers, followed by user execution of the payload. Once executed, the malware establishes persistence via scheduled tasks and process injection, conducts reconnaissance (system information discovery, security software discovery, screen capture, keylogging, clipboard harvesting), and communicates using application-layer protocols. It then masquerades its components, modifies file and directory permissions, and hijacks execution flow. The critical step is the modification of registry settings (T1112) to disable Windows Update and impair Microsoft Defender, culminating in system shutdown or reboot to solidify impact.

Priority technique: T1112 Modify Registry

Priority control: Monitor sensitive registry keys for modification; restrict registry-edit tools for unprivileged users.

Infrastructure and Corroboration

The enrichment data reports no identified hosting providers or autonomous system numbers associated with this activity. Abuse.ch does not corroborate any of the listed malware families, and AbuseIPDB flags no indicators with high confidence. These observations are drawn from the third-party enrichment sources referenced in the source pulse.

Technical Appendix

Ground-truth telemetry from the source pulse; analytical scores are secondary and clearly labelled.

Observed Techniques (ATT&CK, expert-tagged by source)

- T1053.005 Scheduled Task
- T1113 Screen Capture
- T1056.001 Keylogging
- T1115 Clipboard Data
- T1082 System Information Discovery
- T1071 Application Layer Protocol
- T1036 Masquerading
- T1055 Process Injection
- T1112 Modify Registry
- T1222 File and Directory Permissions Modification
- T1204 User Execution
- T1059.001 PowerShell
- T1566 Phishing
- T1562.001 Impair Defenses: Disable or Modify Tools
- T1518.001 Security Software Discovery

- T1189 Drive-by Compromise
- T1574.002 Hijack Execution Flow
- T1490 Inhibit System Recovery
- T1529 System Shutdown/Reboot

Analytical Scores

- Priority technique (graph chokepoint): T1112 Modify Registry (centrality 0.3082).
- Operational risk: Critical (score 1.0, reaches impact).

Behavioral Signature Cluster

- Method: technique-overlap cosine vs 170 MITRE ATT&CK Groups (top overlap 0.4373; reference threshold $\tau = 0.6$).
- These are behavioural resemblances for defensive playbook cross-referencing, not an identity assessment. Where the source pulse names an actor, that attribution is authoritative; the overlaps below neither confirm nor contest it.

Nearest historical profiles by behavioural overlap (resemblance only):

Historical Profile	Behavioural Overlap
APT38	0.4373
APT42	0.4354
Winter Vivern	0.4264
Windshift	0.3917
Daggerfly	0.3892

Enrichment Signal

- Highest AbuseIPDB confidence among IOCs: 0%.

Indicators of Compromise (defanged — non-clickable)

The network and file indicators observed in this activity are listed below for blocklisting:

Type	Indicator
Domain	iualeff[.]net
Domain	gehie246[.]com
Domain	baidu-pan[.]com[.]cn
Domain	steelseries-cn[.]com[.]cn

Type	Indicator
Domain	pc-razerzone[.]com[.]cn
Domain	kaspersky-lab[.]hl[.]cn
Domain	calibre-ebook[.]com[.]cn
Domain	app-microsoft-edge[.]com[.]cn
Domain	sejda[.]hl[.]cn
Domain	translate-youdao[.]hl[.]cn
Domain	zh-diskgenius[.]com[.]cn
Domain	ocam-pc[.]com[.]cn
Domain	cn-drawio[.]com[.]cn
Domain	gw-sogou[.]com[.]cn
Domain	mindmoster[.]com[.]cn
Domain	oijfwe[.]net

Flame Cell // Adversary Pivot [BETA]

BETA. A hypothetical tabletop projection, anchored to documented ATT&CK behaviour and technique co-occurrence across 170 tracked groups. It is not a prediction; treat it as a war-game prompt and review before acting. Spot a pivot that looks wrong? norbert@salacti.com

- **Control applied:** T1112 Modify Registry (persistence)
- **Observed here:** T1112 Modify Registry was the only persistence technique observed in this campaign, so the pivot is projected from cross-actor behaviour.
- **Projected pivot:** T1543 Create or Modify System Process (persistence)
- **Basis:** of the 14+ groups that use Modify Registry, this pairing runs 2.8x above base rate, a disproportionately-coupled move rather than the obvious one.

With T1112 Modify Registry blocked, Void Arachne could preserve the same objective by pivoting to T1543 Create or Modify System Process, a technique disproportionately paired with it across tracked groups. Defensive countermeasure: Restrict service/daemon creation to admins; monitor service and driver installs.

Also plausible (same tactic): T1547 Boot or Logon Autostart Execution (n=17, lift 1.7), T1505 Server Software Component (n=11, lift 2.0)

Detection and hardening for the pivot (T1543 Create or Modify System Process)

- **Telemetry:** Windows Security / System log; Sysmon
- **Detect:**
 - System 7045 (new service installed); Security 4697 (service installed)
 - Sysmon 1 for sc.exe / services created; unusual ImagePath or user-context services
 - Registry writes under HKLM\SYSTEM\CurrentControlSet\Services
- **Harden:**
 - Restrict service creation to admins; application control on service binaries
 - Baseline installed services and alert on new/anomalous ones
- **MITRE:** M1047 Audit, M1028 Operating System Configuration, M1026 Privileged Account Management · DS0019 Service, DS0024 Windows Registry, DS0009 Process

